



# I work with Medicare, Wisconsin Medicaid, BCBS of WI, UMR, UHC, Cigna, Aetna, and Medicare replacement plans and Medicaid replacement plans

Each of those payers ultimately anchors to Medicare's global surgery rules, then layers its own reimbursement quirks on top. A practical PDF for you should treat **CMS global policy as the base** and then flag payer-specific variations you watch for.<sup>[1] [2]</sup>

## Medicare (Traditional + Advantage)

- Uses CMS global indicators: **000, 010, 090, XXX, YYY, ZZZ**; global days are visible in the **Medicare Physician Fee Schedule (MPFS) Look-Up Tool** and in Medicare contractor calculators (Novitas, Palmetto, Noridian, etc.).<sup>[2] [3] [1]</sup>
- Medicare Advantage (replacement) plans generally **mirror MPFS global days**, but may alter:
  - Pre-cert/authorization requirements for major surgeries.
  - Post-op visit billing rules in SNF/home health situations.
  - Modifier handling (especially 54/55/56 and 78/79 for returns to the OR).

## Wisconsin Medicaid

- Wisconsin Medicaid policy follows the Medicare global framework but may publish its **own global days key or code lists**, often derived from NCCI and CMS tables.<sup>[4] [5]</sup>
- Watch for:
  - Service carve-outs even during global (e.g., some critical care, dialysis, unrelated E/M with proper modifier).
  - Prior authorization rules for major surgeries that differ from Medicare timelines.

## BCBS of Wisconsin

- Commercial BCBS plans generally **adopt CMS-style global periods**, but policy manuals (often titled "Global Surgery" or "Global Days") define which services are considered part of the package and which are billable separately.<sup>[6] [7]</sup>
- Common differences:
  - Stricter interpretation of what is "related" to the surgery for E/M within global.

- Plan-specific instruction on when Modifier 25 vs 57 is appropriate for office visits near the time of surgery.

## UMR, UHC, Cigna, Aetna

- These large commercial payers typically:
  - Use Medicare global periods as the **baseline** for physician services.<sup>[5] [8]</sup>
  - Issue plan-specific reimbursement policies (often titled "Global Surgery," "Global Days," or "Minor and Major Procedures") that:
    - Define inclusive vs exclusive services within the global.
    - Spell out exactly how to use Modifiers 54/55/56, 58, 78, and 79.
    - Sometimes restrict separate payment for post-op E/M more than CMS would.
- Many of these payers host **online global calculators or policy PDFs** in their provider portals; these are excellent to link in your own internal PDF as references.<sup>[3] [9] [10]</sup>

## Medicare/Medicaid Replacement Plans

- Medicare Advantage and Medicaid managed care plans **administratively follow Medicare/Medicaid**, but:
  - May require **different authorization and documentation** to recognize post-op complications vs routine global care.
  - Sometimes publish their own "Global Surgery" reimbursement policies that override default CMS interpretations for payment (not coding) purposes.<sup>[8] [6]</sup>

If you want, the next step can be a **payer appendix section** you can paste into your PDF, with one short subsection per payer (Medicare, WI Medicaid, BCBS WI, UMR/UHC, Cigna, Aetna, MA/MCO) listing: "Global period source," "Where to verify," and "Key modifier notes."



1. <https://www.cms.gov/medicare/payment/fee-schedules/physician/global-surgery-data-collection>
2. <https://med.noridianmedicare.com/web/jeb/specialties/surgery/global-surgery>
3. <https://www.novitas-solutions.com/webcenter/portal/MedicareJH/GlobalSurgeryCalc>
4. [https://www.medicaid.ms.gov/wp-content/uploads/2014/10/NCCI\\_GlobalSurgicalDays.pdf](https://www.medicaid.ms.gov/wp-content/uploads/2014/10/NCCI_GlobalSurgicalDays.pdf)
5. <https://imedclaims.com/global-period-in-medical-billing/>
6. <https://www.bridgespanhealth.com/provider/library/policies-guidelines/reimbursement-policy/global-days>
7. <https://www.bluecrossnc.com/providers/policies-guidelines-codes/commercial/reimbursement/updates/global-surgery>
8. <https://auctusgroupconsulting.com/global-period-in-medical-billing/>
9. <https://www.findacode.com/tools/global-days.php>
10. <https://palmettogba.com/jmb/did/g0sicu4hwc>

